

Decision Memo

21st Ave S & S Walker St – Giddens School & Lake Washington Girls Middle School

1/16/2024

<u>X</u> <u>Matt Beaulieu</u> Matt Beaulieu (May 8, 2024 12:47 PDT) Matt Beaulieu, Operations and Review Manager; Transportation Operations	<u>X</u> <u>N. V. S.</u> Venu Nemani (Apr 29, 2024 12:25 PDT) Venu Nemani, City Traffic Engineer
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Recommendation:

- Install all-way stop control (AWSC) at 21st Ave S & S Walker St.
- Recommending Staff: Sara Colling, Safe Routes to School Program Manager
Engineer: Samuel Yemane, Civil Engineer X Samuel Yemane
Samuel Yemane (Apr 29, 2024 12:25 PDT)

Background:

The intersection of **21st Ave S & S Walker St** is a four-way intersection with a traffic circle and is currently uncontrolled. It is located at the southwest corner of the Giddens School and Lake Washington Girls Middle School's campus. This intersection is part of a walkway project on 21st Ave S that will connect to the school. Both streets are classified as non-arterial streets and are neighborhood yield streets.

Table 1: Intersection Details

Intersection	Type	Marked Crosswalks	Other
21st Ave S & S Walker St	4 legged uncontrolled with traffic circle	None	Pedestrian Priority Investment Network

Support:

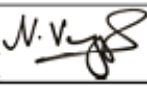
This intersection is a key connection for students walking and biking to Gidden School and Lake Washington Girls Middle School. The intersection is currently uncontrolled within the school zone and connects to walkways to the campus of Gidden School and Lake Washington Girls Middle School.

Per the 2022 SDOT All Way Stop Control Policy memo, these conditions meet the criteria stated in the policy which allows for the installation of all-way stop controls independent of MUTCD volume criteria. Improvements at this intersection may help in facilitating the number of school children walking and biking to and from school and help in improving clarity of right-of-way for inexperienced users. For these reasons, it is recommended to upgrade this intersection with all-way stop controls and marked crosswalks.

Appendix A: 2022 SDOT Policy for Applications of All Way Stop Control for Non-Principal Arterial Intersections

Decision Memo

Thursday, June 30, 2022

 X <u>Dusty Rasmussen (Jun 30, 2022 16:02 PDT)</u> Dusty Rasmussen, Interim Director Transportation Operations	 X <u>Venu Nemani (Jun 30, 2022 15:56 PDT)</u> Venu Nemani, City Traffic Engineer Transportation Operations
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Recommendation MWTS 6/30/2022

- Expand the use of All Way Stop Control (AWSC) near schools and neighborhood greenways/stay healthy streets

Background:

Seattle adopted Vision Zero in February 2015 to eliminate serious injury and fatal collisions on city streets by 2030. From 2016 to 2021, 75% of people killed on Seattle streets were vulnerable travelers. High speeds and failure to yield to people walking are two of the main contributing factors for fatal collisions. Applying effective engineering countermeasures to address these behaviors is critical to improving safety and advancing Seattle's Vision Zero efforts.

Purpose:

The need for volume thresholds to be met presents a challenge on low volume non-principal arterials that may otherwise benefit from an AWSC implementation, due to other contributing conditions. This update expands all-way stop considerations to non-principal arterials within school zones and those designated as neighborhood greenway and/or stay healthy streets under specified conditions.

Application:

Volumes considered for multi-way stops shall include people¹ walking, rolling, or biking, in addition to vehicle volumes on both major and minor streets. MUTCD volume criteria for multi-way stops should be applied at 100 percent of the minimum volume thresholds at intersections involving principal arterial streets. The same volume criteria may be reduced to 60 percent of the minimum volume thresholds at intersections not involving principal arterial streets where the intersection meets one or more of the following conditions:

- Vehicle volumes on the intersecting streets have a ratio between 1:1 to 3:1
- Pedestrian/non-motorized crossing volume peaks at greater than 75 per hour across the major street.
- Intersections within 1/8 of a mile on higher volume street are stop controlled
- Within a school zone

Additionally, when an intersection is in close proximity or adjacent to school buildings, grounds or parcels and has been identified as a focal point for school related travel, a multi-way stop control may be installed independent of MUTCD volume criteria, if the intersection is a collector arterial with AWDT less than 3,000 vehicles per day or is a non-arterial intersection.

At the intersection of two non-arterial streets that are both designated as neighborhood greenways and/or stay healthy streets, multi-way stop control may be installed independent of the MUTCD volume criteria.